

VOLUNTEER AND INTERNSHIP POLICY

1. Purpose

This policy establishes a formal structure for engaging volunteers and interns in meaningful roles that support the objectives of GIFON while providing opportunities for skill development, civic engagement, and professional exposure.

2. Scope

Applies to:

- All individuals volunteering their time and services to GIFON
- Students or graduates undergoing structured internships (academic or professional)
- All departments, programs, and events involving such individuals

3. Objectives

- To define eligibility and engagement procedures for volunteers and interns

- To foster talent development and capacity building in geospatial fields
- To ensure that all engagements align with GIFON's strategic goals and standards
- To uphold professionalism, safety, and mutual respect in all engagements

4. Definitions

- **Volunteer:** An individual who willingly provides unpaid services to support GIFON activities without expectation of financial gain.
- **Intern:** A student or recent graduate engaged in a time-bound, supervised learning opportunity to gain practical experience.

5. Eligibility Criteria

Volunteers

- Must be at least 18 years old (or 16 with parental consent)

- Have a demonstrable interest in geospatial intelligence or development work
- Must submit a completed application and undergo screening
- Willingness to commit time and uphold GIFON values

Interns

- Must be enrolled in or a graduate of a recognized tertiary institution
- Studying or studied geospatial science, GIS, environmental studies, computer science, geography, surveying, or related fields
- Must submit an internship proposal, resume, and letter from institution (where applicable)
- Must undergo an interview or screening by the relevant department

6. Categories and Duration

Type	Duration	Nature
Short-Term	1 day — 1	Event support, outreach,
Volunteer	month	logistics
Long-Term	1 — 6	Administrative, technical, or

Type	Duration	Nature
Volunteer	months	program support
Academic Intern	3 – 6 months	Structured, supervised program tied to academic credit
Professional Intern	3 – 12 months	Postgraduate or early-career experience-building

7. Recruitment and Selection Process

1. Open call or expression of interest via website or partner institutions
2. Submission of application form and supporting documents
3. Review by Volunteer/Internship Coordinator
4. Interview or orientation (virtual or in person)
5. Formal placement and signing of agreement or terms of engagement

8. Orientation and Induction

All selected volunteers/interns will undergo:

- Welcome orientation
- Briefing on GIFON mission, policies, and programs

- Role-specific training and code of conduct induction

9. Rights and Responsibilities

Volunteers and Interns Have the Right To:

- Be treated with respect, dignity, and fairness
- Receive clear role descriptions and expectations
- Access supervision and mentoring
- Be acknowledged for their contributions
- Learn and grow within a supportive environment

Volunteers and Interns Are Expected To:

- Commit to agreed schedules and responsibilities
- Adhere to all GIFON policies including confidentiality, conduct, and data use
- Respect team hierarchy and reporting lines
- Communicate promptly in case of absence or withdrawal

10. Supervision and Evaluation

- Each volunteer/intern will be assigned a supervisor or mentor
- Regular check-ins and task reviews will be conducted

- Interns will receive feedback and a completion certificate/report
- Volunteers may request letters of recognition or recommendation

11. Stipends and Benefits

- GIFON may offer stipends for transport, meals, or specific assignments (subject to budget)
- Volunteers and interns are not considered employees and are not entitled to salaries or employment benefits
- Access to training, events, and networking opportunities is encouraged

12. Conduct and Disciplinary Action

- Any misconduct, breach of policy, or unprofessional behaviour may lead to warnings or termination of engagement
- Serious issues may be escalated to the Executive Director and documented in personnel records

13. Health, Safety, and Insurance

- GIFON will take reasonable steps to ensure a safe working environment

- Interns and volunteers must disclose any medical conditions or disabilities to be accommodated appropriately
- Insurance for work-related injuries will be provided where required

14. Exit and Completion

- An exit interview or feedback form shall be completed
- Interns may be required to submit a final report or presentation
- Completion certificates and recommendation letters are issued upon successful participation

15. Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed every two years or as required to ensure relevance and compliance with national labour and education regulations.